Department of Education
Region X - Northern Mindanao
DIVISION OF BUKIDNON

BULIG

BUKIDNON'S UNIFIED LITERACY AND INTERVENTION GATEWAY

Building Up Literacy, Inspiring Growth



LEVEL 6

GRADED READING COMPREHENSION

GRADE 9

READING TOOLKIT

Bukidnon ZEAL
LIG-ON BUKIDNON

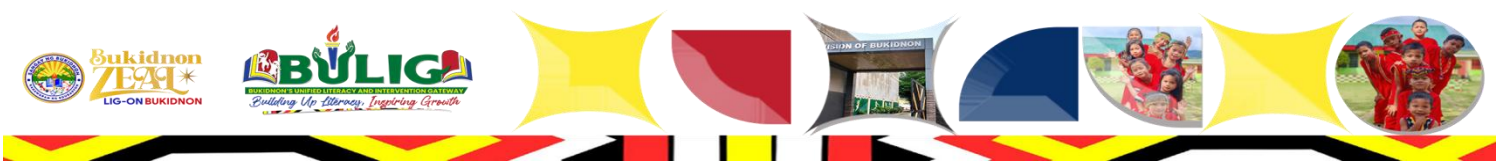
BUKIDNON'S UNIFIED LITERACY AND INTERVENTION GATEWAY (BULIG)
"DIVISION INNOVATION TO IMPROVE LEARNERS' READING ABILITY"
Level 6 – Graded Reading Comprehension (Grade 9)

First Edition, 2025

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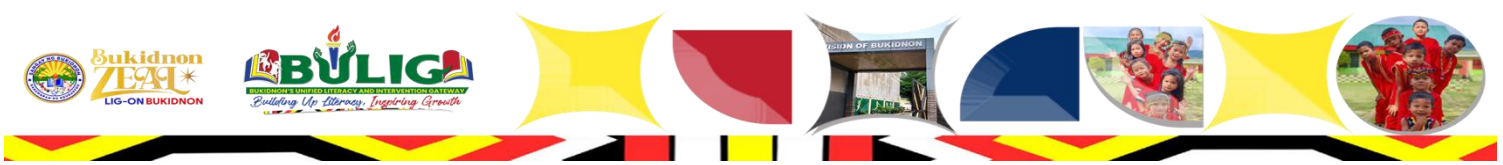
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PREFACE

Reading remains the cornerstone of all learning, yet it continues to be one of the most persistent and complex challenges confronting basic education today. In response to this need, the Schools Division of Bukidnon proudly introduces the **Bukidnon's Unified Literacy and Intervention Gateway (BULIG)**—a division-wide transformative innovation designed to strengthen reading proficiency, accelerate learning recovery, and ensure that every learner develops the literacy skills necessary for academic success and lifelong learning.

BULIG is not merely a program; **it embodies a unified literacy movement** grounded in collaboration, evidence-based practices, and a strong commitment to equity and inclusivity in education. Guided by its tagline, **"Building Up Literacy, Inspiring Growth," BULIG** aspires to cultivate a culture where reading is valued, supported, and sustained—empowering learners to reach their full academic and personal potential.

By harmonizing instructional approaches, consolidating reading intervention materials, and promoting consistent implementation across schools, **BULIG** provides a coherent and adaptive support system that responds to the diverse needs of learners. It seeks to close longstanding gaps in reading performance, strengthen teacher capacity, and institutionalize effective and sustainable literacy practices.

Central to the implementation of **BULIG** is its alignment with the **ARAL Program (Academic Recovery and Accessible Learning)**—DepEd's national learning recovery initiative. By integrating ARAL's targeted intervention cycles, diagnostic assessments, and remediation strategies, **BULIG** strengthens its capacity to address learning loss, support struggling readers, and reinforce foundational skills essential for progression in the curriculum. This synergy ensures that learners receive timely, differentiated, and research-informed interventions that enable them to overcome reading challenges and build confidence.

Through the unified efforts of **BULIG** and ARAL, the Division of Bukidnon envisions **classrooms where every learner reads with fluency, comprehends with accuracy, and engages with texts meaningfully**. The initiative aspires to cultivate empowered, independent readers equipped with the skills necessary for higher-order learning, academic excellence, and holistic development.

As we move forward, let us affirm our collective commitment to making literacy not only a priority but a **guaranteed reality** for all learners. Through shared responsibility, strong instructional leadership, and unwavering dedication to quality basic education, we can ensure that no Bukidnon learner is left behind in the pursuit of literacy and lifelong learning.

BULIG Bukidnon! Lig-on Bukidnon!

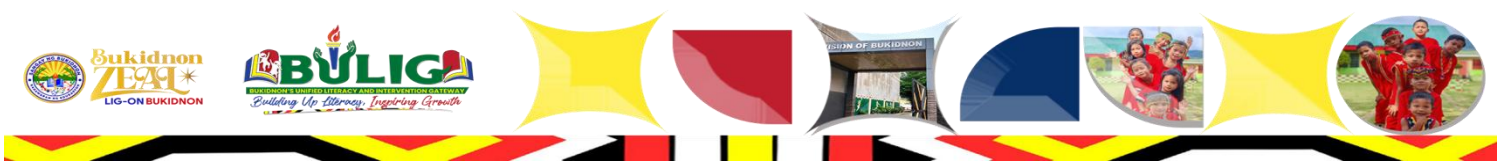
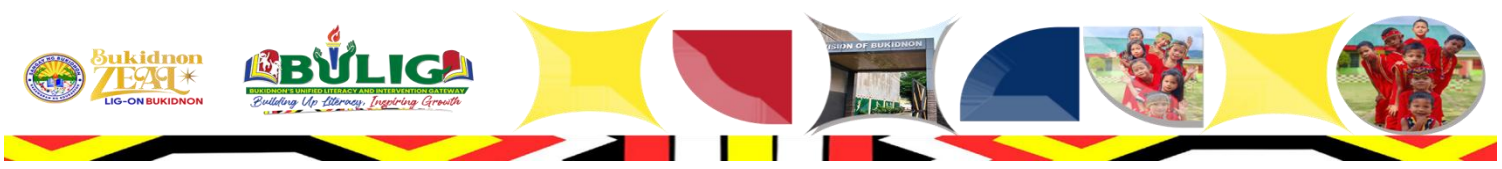


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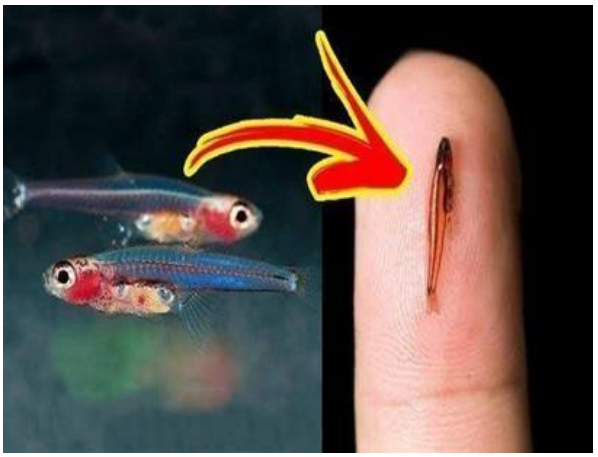


THE SMALLEST FISH IN THE WORLD

Before 1925, the "tabios" was thought to have been the smallest fish in the world. A full-grown "tabios" measured a fraction over eleven millimeters. The "tabios" is found in Lake Buhi, in the Bicol Region of Luzon.

In 1925, Dr. Albert Herre, an ichthyologist, was assigned by the American government to identify and describe Philippine fishes. From a collection of the Philippine National Museum, he found the prototypes of a still smaller type of fish. There were 75 of the tiny fish which he named Pandaka Pygmaea in a bottle. They were so small that the "tabios" appeared big by comparison.

When Dr. Herre went back to the United States, he sent a few specimens to the Stanford National Science Museum. Dr. Herre's findings were doubted because this fish remained a rarity. No one had ever seen a live specimen of the fish that Dr. Herre claimed was the smallest fish in the world.



On February 28, 1951, Ricardo Esguerra, one of the marine biologists working in the saltwater experiments station of the Bureau of Fisheries in Malabon, Rizal, excitedly called up the Bureau's main office and announced that he had found live specimens of the Pandaka. Inocencio Ronquillo, an expert of the Bureau, hurried to the experiment station and studied the tiny fish which had eluded scientists for many years. He measured and weighed them. To confirm his findings, Ronquillo wrote to the curator of Stanford University Museum of Natural Science and asked for some specimens of the fish that Dr. Herre had taken before.

Finally, Dr. Leonard Schulz, the museum's representative, pronounced that they were one and the same type. Thus after 25 years, the Philippines could at least claim to have the world's smallest fish. The Pandaka has now been found in various parts of the Philippines.

The smallest fish is known under the scientific name of Pandaka Pygmaea. Samples have been sent to the museums and aquariums of cities all over the world.

The Pandaka's average length when full-grown is 9.66 millimeters or about the size of a grain of rice. It has a moderately elongated body that is wedge-shaped when viewed from above. Its head is large in proportion to its size. Its eyes protrude. It has two rows of teeth on either side of the jaw, the outer teeth being larger and more widely set than the inner row.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1. Why was the discovery of Pandaka pygmaea in the Philippines in 1925 considered historically important?

A. It showed that all tabios populations had gone extinct

B. It was then regarded as the smallest known fish in the world

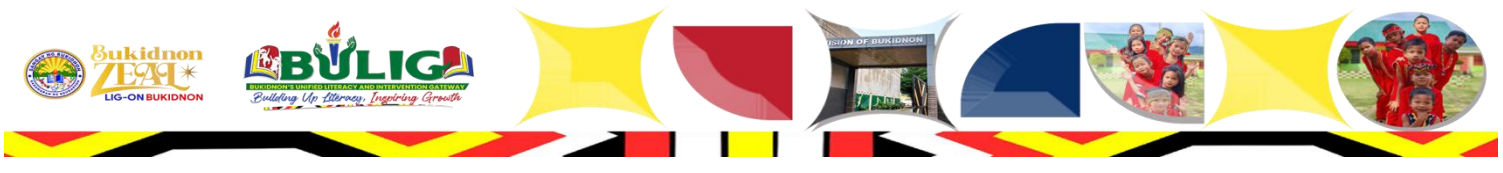
C. It was the first marine fish ever described from the Philippines

D. It proved that all small fish in the Philippines were juveniles

2. What was Dr. Albert Herre's main role in the history of Pandaka pygmaea?

A. He first described and named Pandaka pygmaea in 1925

B.He reclassified tabios as Pandaka pygmaea in 1951



C.He proved that Pandaka pygmaea lives only in deep ocean trenches

D.He led a campaign to ban fishing of all small fish in the Philippines

3. How did Ricardo Esguerra contribute to the story of Pandaka pygmaea in 1951?

A. He replaced Pandaka pygmaea with tabios in scientific classification

B. He officially declared Pandaka pygmaea extinct in the wild

C. He moved all remaining Pandaka pygmaea to foreign aquariums

D. He rediscovered Pandaka pygmaea in the Philippines after fears it had disappeared

4. In historical discussions, why is the local fish known as tabios often mentioned alongside Pandaka pygmaea?

A.Tabios and Pandaka pygmaea are the same species under different general

B.Tabios is the scientific name that replaced Pandaka pygmaea

C.Tabios was initially thought to be the true smallest fish, later replaced by Pandaka pygmaea

D.Tabios is a local small fish whose fame was overshadowed by Pandaka pygmaea as the "smallest fish"

5. Which statement best describes the typical habitat historically associated with Pandaka pygmaea in the Philippines?

A. Clear, fast-flowing mountain streams

B. Shallow coastal or estuarine areas, often near mangroves

C. Deep, open-ocean pelagic zones

D. High-altitude crater lakes far from the sea

6. From a biological perspective, why is the tiny adult size of Pandaka pygmaea scientifically intriguing?

A. It demonstrates that only deep-sea fish can become very small

B. It challenges ideas about the lower size limits of vertebrate bodies

C. It proves that all small fish grow into large fish later

D. It shows that small fish cannot reproduce successfully

7. Historically, how did the "smallest fish in the world" label affect public and scientific attention toward Pandaka pygmaea?

A. It shifted all attention away from Philippine biodiversity

B. It led to the immediate banning of all fishing in its habitat

C. It turned Pandaka pygmaea into a globally cited example of extreme miniaturization

D. It caused scientists to ignore Pandaka pygmaea as unimportant

8. What does the historical replacement of tabios in popular discussion by Pandaka pygmaea as the "smallest fish" mainly illustrate?

A. That local fish names are always incorrect

B.That only foreign scientists can discover important species

C.That large fish are more important than small fish

D.That scientific records and media can reshape which species the public notices

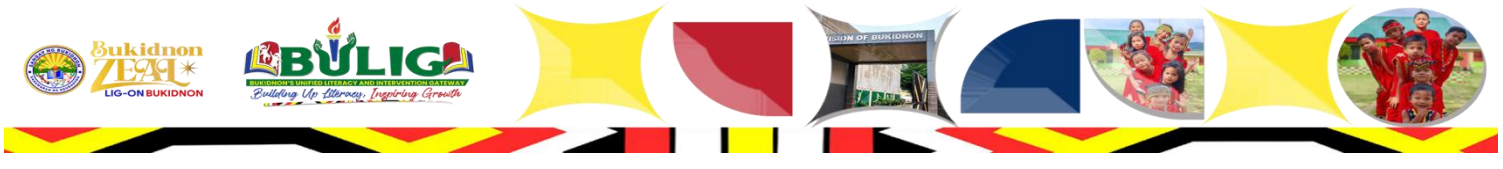
9. Why is it important for modern students in the Philippines to learn about the historical discovery and rediscovery of Pandaka pygmaea?

A. It teaches only that foreign scientists are superior

B. It shows that biodiversity is only found in other countries

C. It highlights the value of both foreign and Filipino contributions to understanding local biodiversity

D. It proves that small fishes are useless for food



10. What conservation lesson can be drawn from the story of Pandaka pygmaea's small size and specialized habitat?

A.Conservation is only needed in remote, untouched wilderness areas

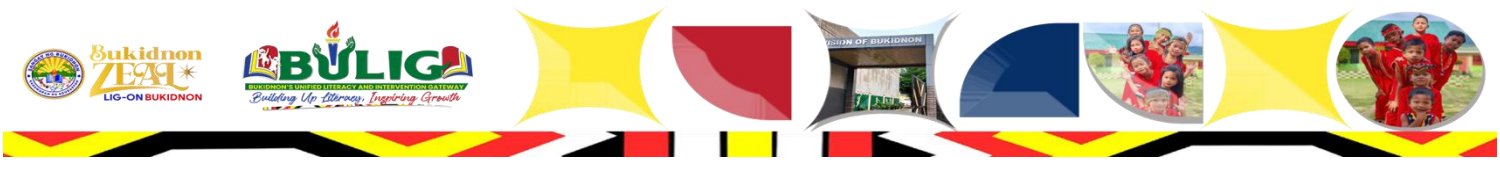
B.Only large, commercially valuable fish deserve protection

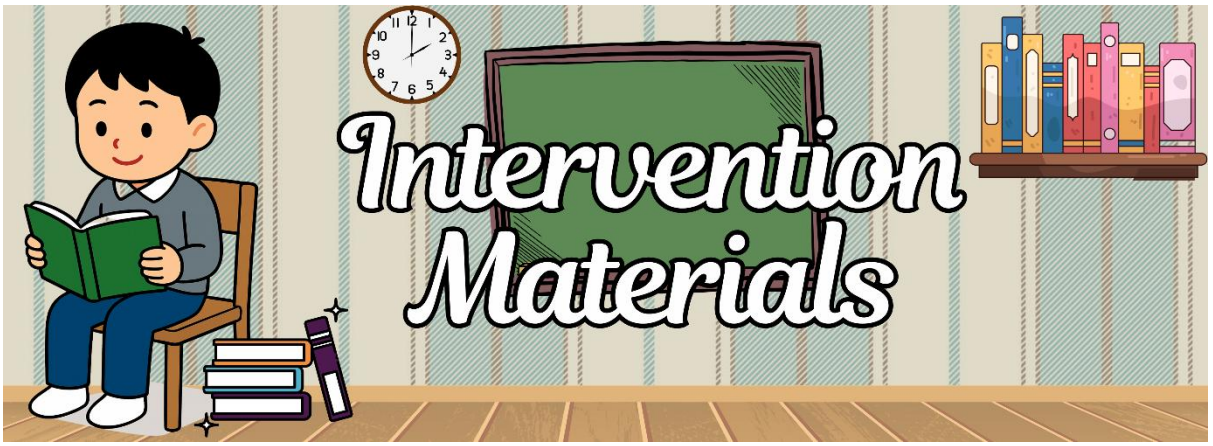
C.Protecting mangroves and coastal wetlands can help safeguard even the smallest, most specialized species

D.Small fish are too numerous to be affected by habitat loss

Answer Key

1. A 2. B 3. A 4. C 5. D 6. B 7. A 8. C 9. B 10. A




Intervention
Materials

Activity 1

LET THERE BE NO GRUDGES

This story is about a young boy who got into a fight with his elder brother. Enoch is his name, and his elder brother would always pick on him to the extent of making him angry and feeling bitter later.

One morning they were it again. They fought hard and exchanged blows with each other. Somewhat outmatched because Enoch was wanting in size and height, he took quite a beating. His elder brother's muscles were too much for him. His pride and ego suffered the most. The whole incident left him bitter towards his elder brother. As a matter of fact, he refused to talk or look at his brother. He was gritting his teeth with anger for not being able to put up square fight.

Bedtime came. Their mother wanted to pacify them and told them to make up as soon as possible.



Enoch was still grumbling, but his eyes were fixed towards the elder brother's direction. Then the mother spoke to the younger one. "Don't you think you should forgive your brother before you go to bed?" Remember the Bible says, "Don't let the sun go down on your wrath."

The younger son looked toward his mother with perplexity. He thought for a few seconds and then said, "Mother, how can I keep the sun from going down?" The boy's question revealed that he had no intention of getting rid of his grudge.

So, the mother explained to her younger son and made him understand what life would be like when people hold grudges against

each other. It is true that there are people with an unforgiving attitude and true too, that we cannot change another person's heart.

She further explained that we cannot keep the sun from going down. But we can keep it from setting on your anger. And that means we must forgive.

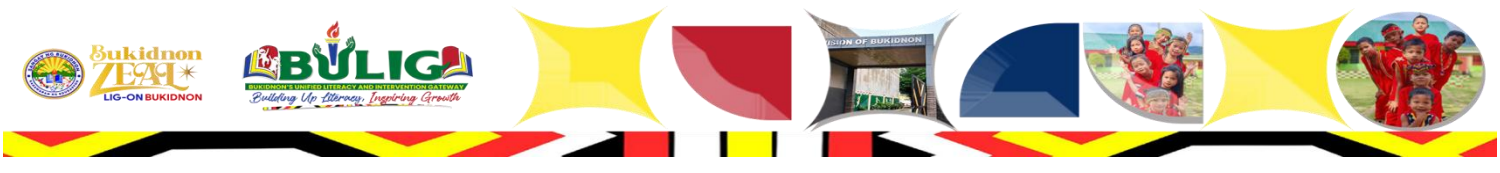
COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. What is the name of the younger boy in the story?
   a) Elias
   b) Ethan
   c) Ezra
   d) Enoch

2. Why was Enoch outmatched in the fight?
   a) He was much taller
   b) His brother avoided punches
   c) He lacked size and height
   d) He refused to fight back

3. What did Enoch refuse to do after the fight?
   a) Eat dinner
   b) Talk to or look at his brother
   c) Go to bed
   d) Help with chores



4. What Bible quote did the mother reference?

a) "Don't let the sun go down on your wrath"

b)"Love your neighbor"

c) "Forgive seventy times seven"

d) "Turn the other cheek"

5. What was Enoch's literal response to his mother's advice?

a) "I'll try tomorrow"

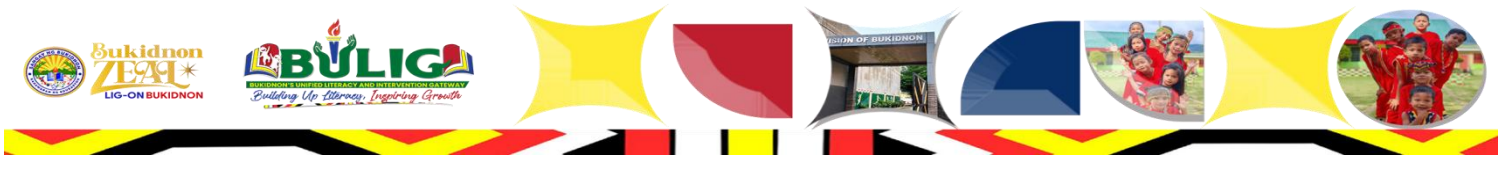
b) "Mother, how can I keep the sun from going down?"

c) "He started it!"

d) "I forgive him now"

Answer Key

1. d) Enoch
2. c) He lacked size and height
3. b) Talk to or look at his brother
4. a) "Don't let the sun go down on your wrath"
5. b) "Mother, how can I keep the sun from going down?"



Activity 2

THE VALUE OF WORK

Everything has value, no matter how insignificant or simple it is. At the mere mention of work, one immediately connects with the idea of toil and fatigue, which pertains to a slave who overdoes things in a difficult manner. Everything in this world involves work.

In what light should work be viewed? Anything that comes from something done is achieved by means of labor and work. It is of two-fold nature, either mental or physical. Both are indispensable to the well-being of human society. Our attention is directed towards physical labor.

Christianity teaches us to regard work as something sacred and honorable. Work is duty. You must not only work hard, but you must also love it wholeheartedly. Without it, order and cleanliness can never exist in the house. A state of affairs would be a mess and discomfort would prevail.

People who work and stay busy have no time for hanging around, gossiping, or being with bad company. Women who are fond of work are more virtuous and purer. There is no dull moment in their lives, there is so much to gain when they are physically occupied.



Be proud, therefore, and love your work. Do it diligently and make it your best. Treat it as an inseparable friend. Whatever the nature of your work may be,

do it with care and diligence. If it is a domestic chore, do not find fault and make critical remarks, but put your hand at everything.

If your work is to be really done well, if it is to gain merit for yourself, perform it with a good intention. Yes, be patient, for without patience, no labor, toil, or work can be meritorious in the eyes of someone above.

These lines speak well of this: Swiftly time speeds on its way. See that thou use it well. Let each hour of every day be a tale of wisdom to tell.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. What immediate association does the passage make with the mention of "work"?
   a) Sacred duty
   b) Value and simplicity
   c) Toil and fatigue
   d) Mental achievement

2. According to the passage, work has what kind of nature?
   a) Only physical
   b) One-fold
   c) Only mental
   d) Two-fold: mental or physical

3. What does Christianity teach about work?

a) It is sacred and honorable

b) It causes gossip

c) It is optional

d) It leads to discomfort

4. What do people who work and stay busy avoid, per the passage?

a) Hanging around, gossiping, or bad company

b) Dull moments

c) Cleanliness

d) Virtue

5. What must accompany work to make it meritorious "in the eyes of someone above"?

a) Good intention and patience

b) Overdoing things

c) Fault-finding

d) Criticism

Answer Key

1. *c) Toil and fatigue*
2. *d) Two-fold: mental or physical*
3. *a) It is sacred and honorable*
4. *a) Hanging around, gossiping, or bad company*
5. *a) Good intention and patience*



Activity 3

TAJ MAHAL: AN IMMORTAL MONUMENT TO AN EMPEROR'S LOVE

In Agra, India, stands an immortal monument to an emperor's love. It was built by Emperor Shah Jahan for his third wife, the beautiful Mumtaz Mahal. Mumtaz, the queen, was born in 1593.

He was a good emperor, and he ruled wisely. During his reign, magnificent buildings and palaces were built. He had a goldsmith build an elaborate throne of rare gems. It was a long, low couch with golden legs. A canopy, which rested on twelve emerald pillars, was over the throne. A tree of diamonds, rubies, emeralds, and pearls stood beside it.

Then, in 1631, Queen Mumtaz Mahal died in childbirth. The emperor was grief-stricken. He forbade music in his court, gave up wearing the colored imperial robes, and wore only white for mourning. A sepulcher was built for her. Twenty thousand workers labored 20 years to complete it. The best artisans, sculptors, designers, and carvers in India and nearby countries were employed under the most renowned architect of those days, Ustad Ahmad.

The monument was made of precious stones and valuable materials. The glorious white marble used comes from India; garnets and lapis lazuli come from Ceylon. All in all, more than 40 varieties of precious stones were used, including turquoise mined in Tibet.

On the north side of the great highway leading to the sepulcher, a tall gateway, 80 feet high, guarded the entrance. The gateway doors were made of silver and studded with semi-precious stones. No less beautiful are the surroundings of the sepulcher. In the waters of the famous reflecting

pool, the image of the tall dome floats eternally in blue. Everything around the place is made to draw the eyes to the central figure of the immortal monument to an emperor's love, the Taj Mahal.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer:

1. What can be inferred about Shah Jahan's leadership style from the description of his building projects and throne?

    a) He ruled without consulting artisans

    b) He prioritized military conquests over arts

    c) He valued opulence and skilled craftsmanship

    d) He avoided using foreign materials

2. Why might the emperor's choice of white robes after Mumtaz's death symbolize more than simple mourning?
    a) It honored the workers' marble labor

    b) It matched the silver gateway colors

    c) It showed his preference for plain fashion

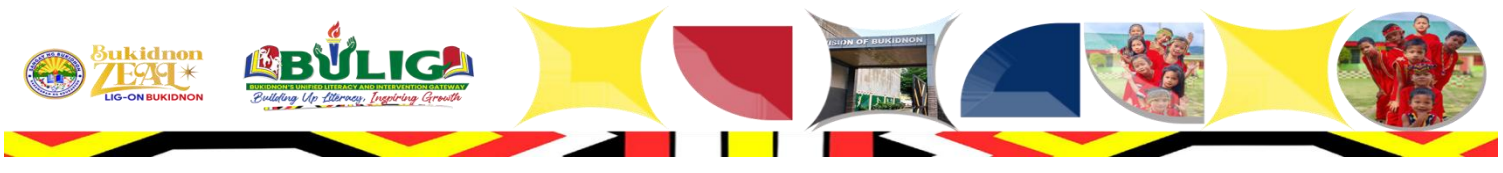
    d) It represented purity of his undying devotion

3. What does the involvement of artisans from "India and nearby countries" suggest about the monument's purpose?
    a) To make it a universal symbol of grief and love

    b) To limit it to local Indian traditions

    c) To create the cheapest possible structure

    d) To compete with European cathedrals



4. How does the reflecting pool's design infer the Taj Mahal's intended emotional impact?
    a) It hides flaws in the marble construction

    b) It evokes eternal beauty mirroring the love

    c) It creates a sense of fleeting impermanence

    d) It focuses attention on the highway gateway

5. What broader inference can be drawn about Mumtaz Mahal's role in Shah Jahan's life from the monument's scale?
    a) She influenced only his architectural tastes

    b) Her death had little effect on his reign

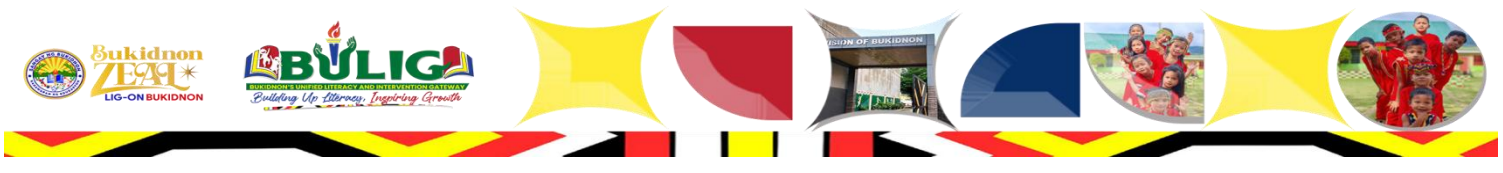
    c) She was a minor consort among many

    d) She was central to his personal and ruling identity

Answer Key

1. c) He valued opulence and skilled craftsmanship
2. d) It represented purity of his undying devotion
3. a) To make it a universal symbol of grief and love
4. b) It evokes eternal beauty mirroring the love

5. d) She was central to his personal and ruling identity



Activity 4

NO LOVE, NO VICTORY

Love is an indispensable necessity for every human heart. But it is of great importance, especially for every young person, to have in his heart a true, genuine, and abiding love of God.

It is said that the decisive battles to be fought are with the devil, the world, and the flesh. However, with the power of love - the love of God - all these can be conquered. It is only when the ardent love of God dwells in one's heart that he may hope to speak of victories. The history of the world, the pages of sacred history, and the history of each individual alike teach us that without love, there can be no victory.

Love, in a general sense, conquers both good and evil things. Think of what inspired heroes in all ages and led them to achieve immortal deeds of glory. What inflamed the heart of Napoleon the Great, pushing himself forward without rest and conquering countries of Europe? It was love for their fatherland.

What causes the miser to suppress the strongest impulse of nature, the desire for food and drink, and literally to die of hunger beside his stock of gold? It is the love of money. What usually compels lovers to commit suicide, conquering even the love of life? Again, it is love which has been rejected.

What is the motive which makes a mother overcome her desire for ease and comfort, sacrificing money, time, health, and everything? It is love for her child. What enables good Christian married people to practice self-control, to overcome selfishness, and to set aside their own wishes? It is love and conjugal affection for each other. And how was the greatest victory over sin, death, and hell, the victory

won by the Redeemer triumphant? It was a victory of the love of God for us, human beings. Such is the all-conquering might of love. Without it, there is no victory.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Fill in the blanks with the correct words.

1. What can be inferred as the primary source of power needed to win "decisive battles" against the devil, world, and flesh?
a) Personal willpower and strategy alone

b) Ardent love of God dwelling in the heart

c) Historical knowledge from sacred pages

d) Rejection of all earthly affections

2. From Napoleon's conquests and the miser's starvation, what does the passage imply about love's influence on human behavior?
a) Love conquers natural impulses like rest, hunger, or self-preservation

b) Love only motivates positive, heroic deeds

c) Love weakens resolve in ambitious people

d) Love requires wealth to achieve victories

3. What can be inferred about a mother's sacrifices from the passage's example?

a) They stem from selfishness masked as care

b) They prioritize her own comfort over the child

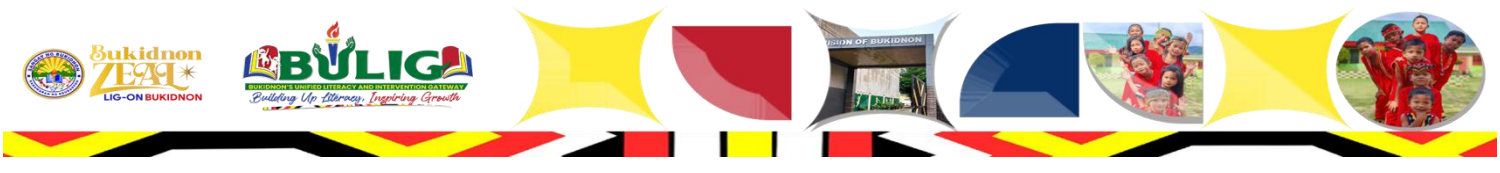
c) They prove love conquers desire for ease, time, and health

d) They are less powerful than romantic love

4. Based on the lovers' suicide and spouses' self-control, what universal truth about love emerges?

a) Love always leads to harmony without struggle

b) Love compels overcoming even the instinct for life or selfishness



c) Love fades when rejected or challenged

d) Love succeeds only in marriage, not individually

5. How does the passage imply Christ's victory over sin, death, and hell relates to all other examples?

a) It demonstrates God's love as the greatest, all-conquering force

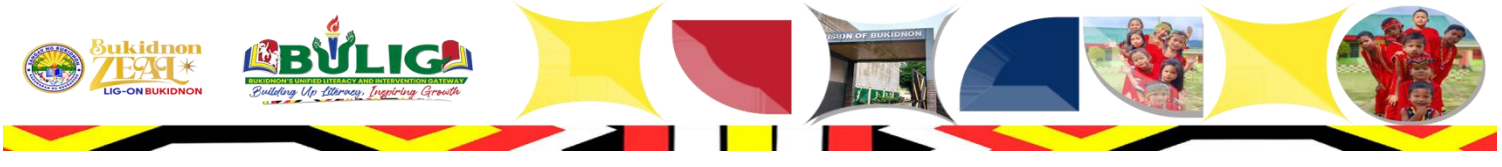
b) It shows victory without any personal cost

c) It relies on human effort more than divine love

d) It is unrelated to earthly loves like patriotism

Answer Key

1. B
2. A
3. C
4. B
5. A



Activity 5

WHAT IS CADETSHIP?

There is more to the glamour and prestige that has always been associated with the Philippine Military Academy; that is, the sacrifice and truth. Blood, sweat, and tears are behind all of these.

First, it is blood, for it is the individual alone who can make himself survive the continuously fluctuating changes and pressures of Academy life.

Second, is sweat - it is the painful process of changing from the carefree ways of civilian life to the exacting demands of military life.

Third, are tears for the joy, pride, and feeling of fulfillment of having survived obstacles, something between life and death.

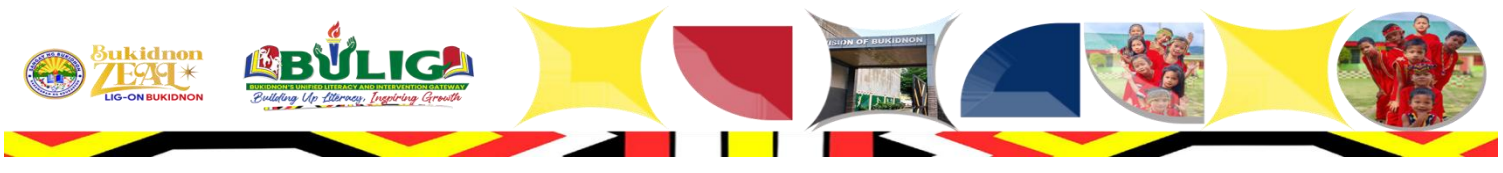
Let it be known, however, that nothing can be a much better source of pride than being able to conquer one's weaknesses and turn them into strengths. Life begins with a very young man so eager to join the ranks of the "long gray line," attracted by its glamour, only to be led down the wrong path upon entering and leaving sooner than he came.

The "Beast Barracks" or Summer Training is something that this same young man feels is too much for him. But it takes some attitude and courage, or guts, so to speak. Once he is in, he is exposed to things he has never dared to think of before. He does things he cannot imagine and wonders how they are done.

Anyway, it is every cadet's goal as he prays to aspire above the level of common life and to adhere to the patterns of their creed - truth, nobility, and excellence.

The Summer Camp Training is a near-perfect program of development and training. One has to survive and surmount it through thick and thin. The feeling to quit is there after a rough time of one month or more.

But when Incorporation Day comes, every sacrifice is compensated. It is better that one finds out for oneself what it really is like to be a part of this closely-knit big family, that is, the Academy.



COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. According to the text, what does "blood" symbolize in the essence of cadetship?
   A) Individual survival amid pressures

   B) Joy and pride from survival

   C) Transition from civilian to military life

   D) Feeling of fulfillment

2. Why does the text describe "Beast Barracks" or Summer Training as pivotal for cadets?
   A) It guarantees Incorporation Day rewards

   B) It exposes cadets to unimaginable challenges requiring guts

   C) It eliminates all feelings of wanting to quit

   D) It focuses only on academic excellence

3. What is the cadet's ultimate goal as per the creed mentioned?
   A) Avoid all obstacles between life and death

   B) Aspire above common life with truth, nobility, and excellence

   C) Embrace carefree civilian ways

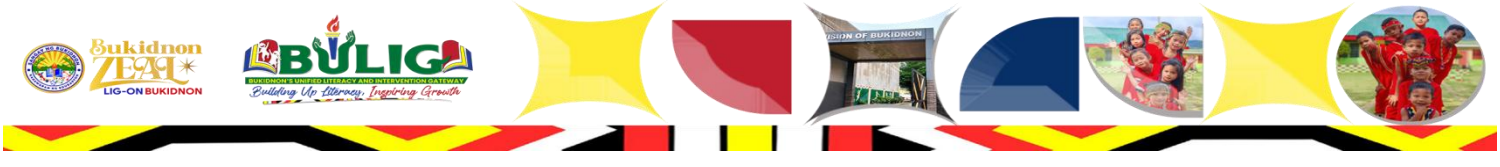
   D) Conquer only physical weaknesses

4. How does the text characterize the transformation during cadetship?
   A) Quick and painless shift to military demands

   B) Tears only from joy on Incorporation Day

   C) Painful sweat from civilian to exacting military life

   D) Pride solely from initial glamour



5. What compensates for the sacrifices of cadetship, per the text?

A) Avoiding the urge to quit

B) Focus on weaknesses alone

C) Early exit from the Academy

D) Incorporation Day's joy, pride, and family bonds

Answer key:

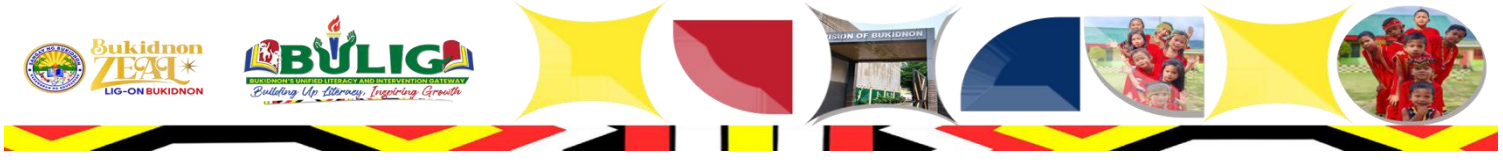
1.A

2.B

3.B

4.C

5.D



Activity 6

HANNIBAL, THE GREAT

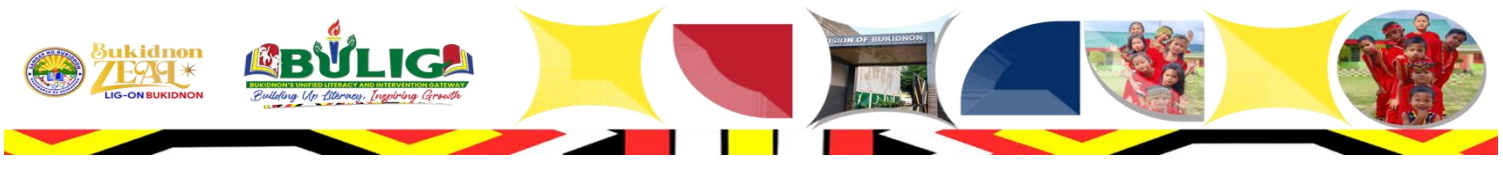
Carthage, a great city-state in North Africa, had grown into power. She had extensive colonies in the African continent, conquered Spain, and was in constant warfare with the Roman Empire and its satellite cities. The war, which had been going on between Rome and Carthage for nearly a century, had been indecisive, with the Carthaginians having lost and won as many battles as the Romans.

In Carthage, there arose a general, Hannibal, who almost destroyed the Roman Empire. No general had ever beaten the famed Roman army in as many battles as Hannibal had, and no army had caused so much fear and destruction as Hannibal's army did.

Hannibal conceived of attacking the Romans in Italy. It was a feat never before made or even dared by any army. He began his invasion with 90,000-foot soldiers, 12,000 horsemen, and 40 elephants. He reached the foot of the Alps and crossed these mountains in nine days. Then, he met the Roman armies.

By swift maneuvers, Hannibal managed to meet the Roman armies one by one. The sight of the giant elephants charging them brought terror to the Roman cavalry. They fled from the fight and were easily defeated. On one occasion, Hannibal found himself completely surrounded. He ordered his army to fasten burning torches on the cattle horns. At midnight, he drove the animals toward a heavily defended enemy front. The terrible sight frightened the Roman ranks and destroyed them completely.

In many of these battles, Hannibal's forces were often outnumbered, but his elephants' juggernaut, the swiftness of his movements, and his brilliant command



gave him victory. For 16 years, Hannibal roamed the Italian peninsula, defeating all the armies sent against him.

Meanwhile, powerful Roman forces had been sent to Carthage. Hannibal was then recalled defending Carthage. However, his forces had been decimated in the Italian campaign.

At Zama, near Carthage, the powerful Roman army met Hannibal's forces. Here, Hannibal met his defeat with a loss of 20,000 men. When peace was concluded, the Romans demanded Hannibal's surrender to Rome.

To escape, Hannibal committed suicide.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. What was the primary strategic innovation of Hannibal's invasion that shocked the Romans?

A. Naval blockade of Italy

B. Overland crossing of the Alps

C. Direct assault on Rome's walls

D. Alliance with Egyptian pharaohs

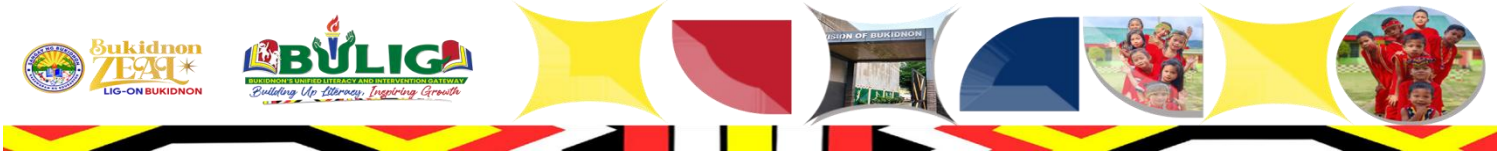
2. At Cannae, Hannibal's double envelopment tactic succeeded because:

A. Roman infantry charged predictably into his weak center

B. Elephants formed the front line

C. Night attack with torch-lit cattle

D. Superior Roman cavalry flanked him



3. Why did Hannibal fail to capitalize on victories like Trebia and Trasimene for total Roman collapse?

A. Lack of siege equipment and Italian city defections

B. Roman elephants outnumbered his

C. Immediate recall to Carthage

D. Gaul tribes betrayed him early

4. At Zama, Scipio Africanus defeated Hannibal mainly by:

A. Outnumbering his elephants 2-to-1

B. Neutralizing Carthaginian cavalry and luring elephants into lanes

C. Burning cattle horns at midnight

D. Starving the Carthaginian army

5. Hannibal's suicide in Bithynia (Libyssa) exemplified his:

A. Defiance against Roman pursuit despite political recovery in Carthage

B. Loyalty to Carthage over personal survival

C. Fear of capture after Zama victory

D. Alliance with Syrian king

Answer key:

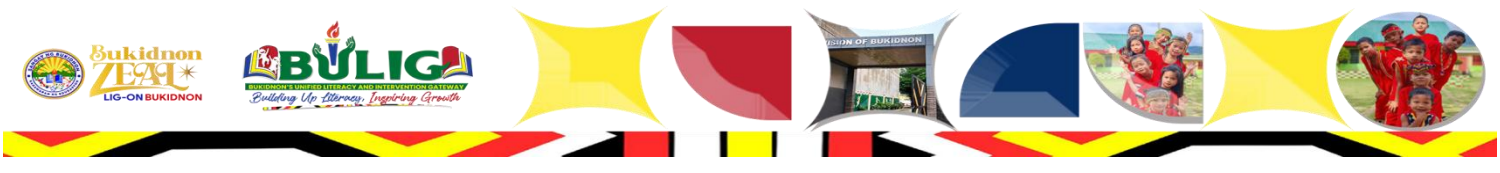
1.B

2.A

3.A

4.B

5.A



Activity 7

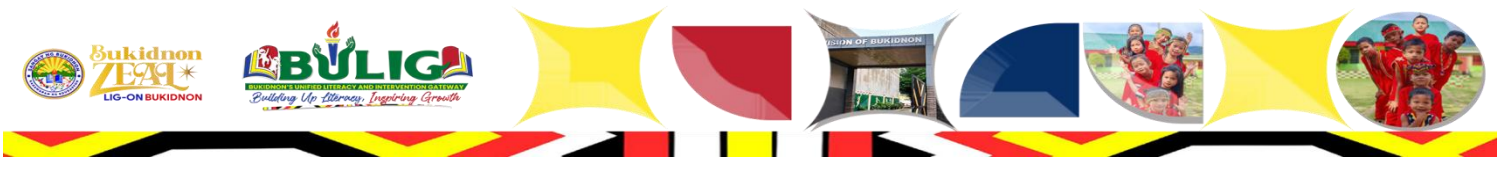
A GOOD TURN DESERVES ANOTHER

In life, there are many things that happen which are least expected. When these things turn to blessings, people's hearts are softened, and they look up above to praise Him in glorious words. Some may just leave occurrences and daily happenings to fate and may keep everything to themselves.

But have you ever gone out of your way to do something for someone and had it go unnoticed? Very often it is difficult to believe that doing good to others is worth the effort, especially when we don't receive a "thank you" in return. And yet, serving without looking for a reward is just like walking with God peacefully. As Christians, we should not display a cash-and-carry attitude, expecting immediate appreciation for the good we do. We must remember that someday he will richly reward us.

A magazine article told of a businessman who facilitated his dealings in the car business with a very young foreigner. The latter bought a new car, and a very fast and honest transaction took place between them. Short of some thousand pesos to complete the full payment, the businessman agreed to collect the amount after two weeks. Two weeks passed, but the buyer still could not produce the amount as his money had not come yet. So a grace period was given and extended to another two weeks. Finally, the deal was over. Everything was paid for.

Ten years later, the young man had become the sole purchasing agent for the Saudi Arabian Contractor's Association. To repay the businessman's hospitality and to show his gratitude for all the conveniences



afforded to him, he placed a million-dollar order for 500 heavy dump trucks and 200 pickups. The businessman blinked his eyes with disbelief. “It’s unbelievable!” he exclaimed. “I just can’t believe it, but it’s true.” The good he had done was rewarded years later, beyond his wildest imagination.

As the lines rightfully say: "Be not weary in your serving; Do your best for those in need. Kindness will be rewarded, By the Lord who prompts the deed."

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. What is the primary theological lesson the text draws from the businessman's story?
   A. God rewards only those who expect immediate payment for good deeds.
   B. Patience in serving others leads to unexpected, abundant blessings over time.
   C. Business success depends on trusting strangers without any risk.
   D. Gratitude from others is unnecessary if faith is strong enough.

2. How does the text contrast a "cash-and-carry attitude" with Christian service?
   A. It portrays the attitude as more efficient for daily life than selfless acts.
   B. It equates it to expecting instant rewards, unlike serving God without anticipation.
   C. It suggests both approaches yield the same long-term results.
   D. It recommends it for non-Christians but not believers.

3. The story of the young foreigner illustrates which key idea about rewards?
   A. Good deeds must be repaid within two weeks to be meaningful.
   B. Grace periods in transactions guarantee future loyalty.
   C. Business deals with foreigners always lead to profit.
   D. Small acts of kindness can yield massive returns after a decade.

4. According to the text, why might people doubt the value of unnoticed good deeds?

A. Due to a lack of verbal thanks, making the effort seem wasted.

B. Because blessings always come quickly and visibly.

C. Since fate handles all outcomes without human input.

D. As serving God requires public displays for validation.

5.What does the closing poem reinforce about the overall message?

A. Rewards come only from human gratitude, not divine prompting.

B. One should serve only those who can reciprocate immediately.

C. Persistent kindness, even when tiring, is divinely rewarded.

D. Weariness in serving proves a lack of true faith.

Answer Key

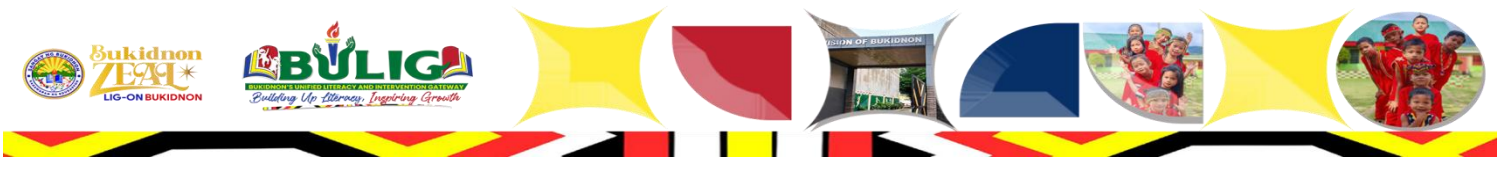
1.B

2.B

3.D

4.A

5.C



Activity 8

THE LION IS DYING

The lion is the largest and most celebrated member of the cat family. It has an apparently large-sized head because of the great mane which covers its head, neck, and shoulders. By the time the lion is five or six years old, it can weigh more than 500 lbs and can be over 9 ½ feet long from the tip of its nose to the tip of its tail.

The lion has the reputation of being fearless, but it is more accurate to describe it as sly. Its instincts are like those of a house cat, and it hunts like a cat. It quietly stalks its prey, then, making a short, quick bound, lands on it. It mauls and bites the head of its victim until its neck is broken, and its veins and arteries are torn open.

The lion will eat anything it can find. While in the prime of its strength, it will hunt all sizes of deer, zebras, and even buffaloes. However, as it grows older, it may live on rodents, scorpions, and tiny creatures, even rotting meat.

The lion was at one time known as the king of the jungle. The jungles of Africa, Asia Minor, and India were once the lion's domain. But man has been slowly but surely exterminating the species. The lion has disappeared in Asia Minor, Iran, and even in many parts of Africa. The remnants of the lion family in Asia are now confined to Northwestern India's GIR forest, a reservation. There, some 160 lions remain, a pathetic remnant of a once prolific species.

However, even in its sanctuary, the lions are losing their natural prey of deer and wild buffaloes because men have encroached on the sanctuary and have domesticated the buffaloes. The lions are forced to

slaughter and feed on domesticated buffaloes, and the herdsmen retaliate by killing the lions.

The king of the jungle is fast becoming extinct. Unless man gives the lions a place where they can live and multiply peacefully, and where their natural diet of deer and other animals can also live, many may never see a lion again except in museums or in picture books.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. What does the passage imply about the lion's reputation for fearlessness?
   A. It stems from its massive size and mane alone
   B. It reflects bold charges against large herds
   C. It is overstated; the lion is actually sly and cat-like in instincts
   D. It matches its habit of eating only prime prey like buffaloes

2. How does the lion's diet as it ages interpret its adaptability?
   A. It shows preference for challenging hunts like deer
   B. It remains focused on large prey throughout life
   C. It declines to scavenging rodents and rotting meat out of necessity
   D. It avoids small creatures to preserve strength

3. What can be inferred from lions' confinement to India's GIR forest?
   A. Humans expanded jungles there for protection
   B. The species thrives despite losing Asian Minor and African ranges
   C. Man's extermination reduced it to a "pathetic remnant" of 160 lions
   D. Natural migration led to this single sanctuary

4. What does the sanctuary encroachment suggest about human-lion conflict?

A. Lions gain more deer prey from domestication

B. Herdsmen support lions by providing buffaloes

C. Lions must raid livestock, prompting retaliation killings

D. Buffaloes multiply naturally inside the reserve

5. The passage's title and conclusion interpret the lion's fate as?

A. Thriving under man's protection in jungles

B. Evolving to new habitats like museums

C. Extinct unless given protected space with natural prey

D. Kingly due to past glory in Africa/India

Answer key:

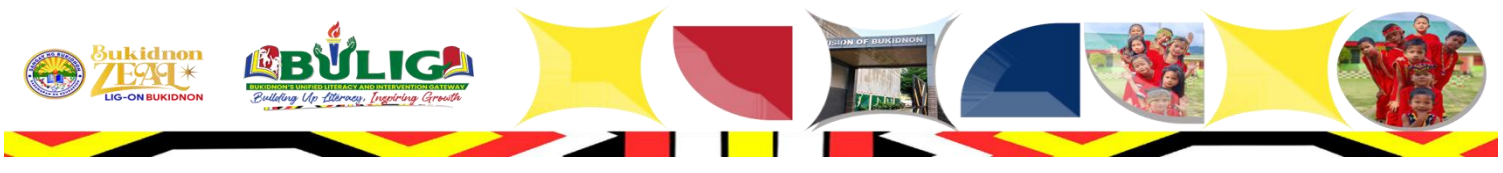
1.C

2.C

3.B

4.C

5.A



Activity 9

IT IS NOT "WHY?" BUT "WHAT?"

When any misfortune or ill luck comes our way, we often ask, "Why me, God? Why should this happen to me?" Then we examine ourselves as to whether we are right in professing our faith or giving the appearance of being one who believes in the professed faith. Something dictates that perhaps it would be better if we ask, "What can I learn from this? What is God teaching me?"

This story is told by a missionary in China many, many years ago about a woman who boarded a train with him in Europe. The first thing the missionary noticed was her radiant face, so sweet, and troubles seemed far from existence. They talked about anything under the sun, and her face would brighten up when mission and religious work were discussed. Obviously, she had not experienced trying circumstances.

As the train sped off and their talk turned into intimate conversation, the missionary observed that the woman's right hand was missing, and in its place was a steel hook. As their talk continued, the missionary learned that this lady friend had been a missionary in India, had contracted a lung disease, and had been sent home to die. So, she returned to her native country, Sweden, bought a farm, and worked daily on it.

One day, while she was working on a threshing machine, her right hand was cut. It was a big blow, a great misfortune in her life, but she accepted it as one of life's trials. She continued: When my hand was cut off, I immediately looked up and said, "Lord, what do you really want me to do now that my right hand is gone? What work? I was not asking why but what?"





What a brave woman! She deserves all the praises this world possesses with her unflinching courage. Her strength of character is really commendable. God used her to turn her farm into a home for the aged, the sick, and the feeble. She is still there, bringing blessings to the unfortunate.

How many adverse circumstances come into your life? Our nature is to question God's designs and workings. He just wants you to show the genuineness of your faith and the adequacy of His grace. So stop asking why. God will show you what.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Fill in the blank with the correct word to complete the sentence.

1. What does the missionary initially infer about the woman's life from her radiant face?
   A. She had never faced trying circumstances
   B. Her faith made troubles nonexistent
   C. She avoided discussing personal hardships
   D. Mission work erased all past pains

2. The woman's response to losing her hand primarily illustrates which attitude toward misfortune?
   A. Resignation to life's inevitable trials
   B. Immediate blame on external causes like machinery
   C. Seeking God's purpose through "What?" instead of "Why?"
   D. Focusing on physical recovery first

3. How does the story interpret the role of adversity in testing faith?
   A. It exposes weaknesses in professed belief

B. God uses it to reveal grace's adequacy

C. Believers must endure without questioning

D. It proves the insincerity of religious work

4. What transformation resulted from the woman's "What?" question after her injury?

A. She abandoned farm work for full-time ministry

B. Her farm became a home blessing the unfortunate

C. She returned to missionary service in India

D. The threshing accident was deemed divine punishment

5. The story's core lesson equates asking "What?" with demonstrating:

A. Unflinching courage and strength of character

B. Superior faith over others' questioning nature

C. Freedom from all adverse life circumstances

D. Praise-worthy bravery alone

Answer key:

1. A
2.C

3.B

4.B

5.A



Activity 10

AKLAN'S MOST ILLUSTRIOUS SON

Jaime L. Cardinal Sin was born on August 31, 1928, in New Washington, Aklan, to Juan Sin and Maxima Lachica. He was ordained as a priest on April 3, 1954; served as the first Rector of St. Pius X Seminary in Roxas City from 1957 to 1967; appointed Auxiliary Bishop of Jaro in March 1967 and later Archbishop of Manila on March 19, 1974. Finally, he was named a Cardinal at the Consistory on May 26, 1976. His chosen motto was "Serviam," which means "to be a servant." Cardinal Sin generously gave himself in complete service and absolute devotion to God and His flock. He displayed dynamic and militant leadership, which was his inspiration in his deep faith and commitment to lead his people to Jesus Christ.

During his elevation to the Cardinalate, he urged everyone to join him in a revolution, a revolution of love. Heeding the needs of his people, he tirelessly fought for the ideals of freedom, truth, and justice. He believed in the separation between the Church and State. Nevertheless, he asserted that the relationship between the two should be collaborative rather than adversarial.

Through his inspired leadership, he united the Filipino people to make the democratic process work in our country, and thus emerged as "People Power." Cardinal Sin's contagious sense of humor seemed to have become a byword. His wit and wisdom presented to us the partnership between humor and intellectual insight. He thought of himself as an elder brother in the task that the Lord had given him. Full of hope for a more humane citizenry, he turned to everyone on this land to tell them, "Let us choose the way of peace. And the way of peace is the way of justice and truth, the way of deep respect before God for the rights of each one."

This was one of his favorite lines: “Man achieves the fullness of his humanity when his dignity is respected, when his freedom to do good is protected. Working hand in hand, the Church and the State can do so much to prevent man’s dehumanization.” Before his death in 2006, he had assailed the continuing graft and corruption in the government and had called for a more vigorous and unrelenting drive against these. His interest called for a change not only in the government but the private sector as well.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the correct answer.

1. What does Cardinal Sin's motto "Serviam" primarily reflect about his approach to leadership?

A. Aggressive confrontation with political powers

B. Complete devotion as a servant to God and people

C. Strict separation from state affairs

D. Focus on personal humility alone

2. During his elevation to Cardinal, what kind of "revolution" did Sin urge, and what does it signify about his vision?

A. Violent overthrow of the government

B. A transformative shift toward love, freedom, truth, and justice

C. Economic reforms in Aklan

D. Internal Church restructuring

3.How did Cardinal Sin view the ideal relationship between Church and State, despite believing in their separation?

A. Completely independent and non-interacting

B. Adversarial to protect religious freedoms

C. Collaborative for the common good, like preventing dehumanization



D. State-dominant with Church submission

4.What interpretive role did Sin play in fostering "People Power," according to the biography?

A. Military strategist against Marcos

B. Uniter of Filipinos to make democratic processes work through non-violent faith-inspired action

C. Silent observer of political events

D. Promoter of elite-only governance

5.What broader change did Sin advocate before his death, beyond just government graft?

A. Only military reforms

B. Anti-corruption drive extending to both government and private sectors for justice and peace

C. Focus solely on Church internal issues

D. Economic aid without accountability

Answer key:

1. B
2. B
3. C
4. B
5. B




Post-Assessment
TEST

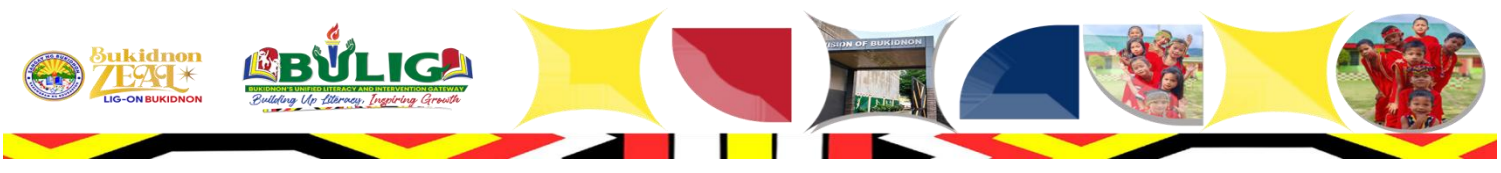
THE OLYMPIC GAMES

People all over the world are thrilled when athletic meets are held in various parts of the globe. World sports bring together athletes from all over. Do you know when and how these Olympic games came about?

The first Olympic games originated in Ancient Greece. These games were first held during the Panhellenic celebrations. Every four years, patriotic and religious games were held during the celebrations. The year 776 B.C. marked the first of such a recorded festival. The Greeks then began to keep their calendar by "Olympiads" from this date or by the four-year span between the games.

Simplicity marked the first Olympic games. It was said that the first consisted of only a foot race of about 200 yards on the plain near the small City of Olympia. As years passed, the kinds of games were increased and led to competitions that brought forward national pride and unity. The competitions were based on fair rules of sportsmanship and justice. However, at first, only Greek citizens were allowed to take part in the games. The winners were crowned with laurel and awarded wild olive and palm wreaths. Winners were also given many special privileges in their respective communities.

During the reign of the Roman rulers, these games went down to the level of carnivals and circuses. Theodosius, one of the Roman emperors, prohibited the holding of the games in 394 B.C. For almost 2,300 years, no Olympic games were held.



Then in 1894, a French educator, Baron Pierre de Coubertin, planned to revive the games. He invited many countries to participate in the athletic meets. The French Baron believed that by means of the youth's love for sports, international understanding would develop.

In 1896, Baron Pierre de Coubertin was able to enlist nine nations to send their athletes to the first Modern Olympics. This marked the beginning of the participation of thousands of athletes representing nearly all nations to compete in these Olympic games which are held every four years in different countries. The Olympic Games are instrumental in bringing together athletes from.

Representatives of different countries compete with each other in games of skill and sportsmanship. The athletes get to know each other very well and learn that all races love the same ideals of fair play, courage, understanding, and friendliness. When the athletes return to their respective countries, they are better world citizens after having participated in activities replete with understanding and brotherhood.





COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

Directions: Choose the letter of the best answer.

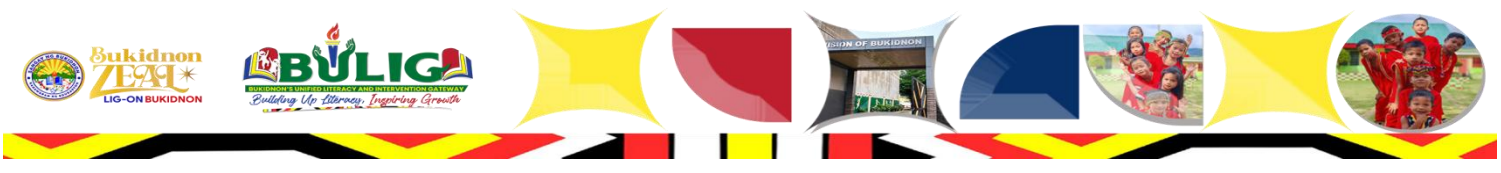
1. In what year was the first recorded Olympic festival held?
   A. 394 B.C.
   B. 776 B.C.
   C. 1896
   D. 1894

2. What marked the simplicity of the first Olympic games?
   A. Laurel wreaths for winners
   B. Only a foot race of about 200 yards near Olympia
   C. Participation by Roman citizens
   D. Carnivals and circuses

3. Who prohibited the Olympic games in 394 A.D.?
   A. Baron Pierre de Coubertin
   B. Greek citizens
   C. Theodosius, a Roman emperor
   D. Panhellenic celebrants

4. What can be inferred about the Greek calendar system from the text?
   A. It counted by months only
   B. It used "Olympiads" as four-year spans starting from 776 B.C.
   C. It began with Roman rulers
   D. It ignored religious festivals

5. Why were winners awarded special privileges in their communities?
A. They represented international unity



B. Their victories promoted national pride during games

C. Games were held annually

D. Only non-Greeks competed later

6. What led to nearly 2,300 years without Olympic games?

A. Decline to carnivals under Romans, then prohibition

B. Increase in foot races only

C. Modern revival in 1894

D. Laurel wreath shortages

7. The text critically suggests Roman influence degraded the games by turning them into what? (Critical)

A. Patriotic unity events

B. Fair sportsmanship competitions

C. Carnivals and circuses

D. Religious Panhellenic festivals

8. Baron de Coubertin's belief implies what interpretive goal for modern Olympics? (Interpretive)

A. Limit to Greek citizens

B. Foster international understanding through youth sports

C. Crown winners with palms only

D. Hold games every year

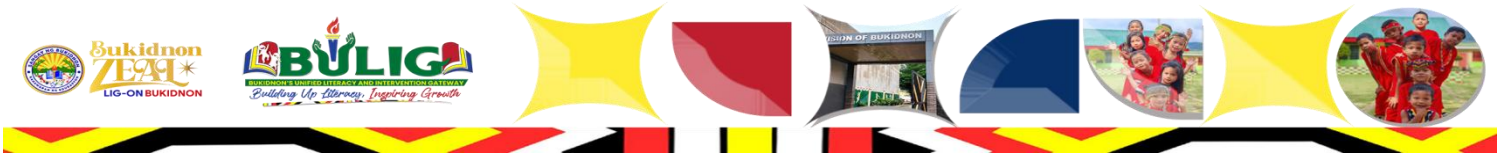
9. How does the text interpret the role of Olympic rules? (Interpretive)

A. Based on injustice for unity

B. Promoted fair play, courage, and brotherhood among nations

C. Allowed only foot races

D. Excluded all privileges



10. Critically, what makes athletes "better world citizens" per the text? (Critical)

A. Winning laurels alone

B. Learning shared ideals like fair play from global interactions

C. Roman carnival participation

D. Local community privileges only

Answer Key

1.B

2. B
3.C

4. B

5. B

6. A

7. C

8. B

9. B

10. B

